



BadCoin Core

User Manual

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1. Welcome

BadCoin Core is the desktop wallet and full node for the BadCoin network. This manual explains what BadCoin is, how the wallet works, and what every tab, button, and console command does.

The wallet is built for people who are new to running a coin as much as for those who are not. You do not need to use the command line, and you do not need prior experience. If you can install an app and follow a few steps, you can run a BadCoin node, hold BAD, and mine it from your own computer.

BadCoin Core is a full node. That means it downloads and verifies the whole BadCoin blockchain itself, rather than trusting someone else's server. Your wallet keys live on your machine and nowhere else. Nobody can freeze your coins and nobody holds them for you, which also means the responsibility for backing them up is yours. This manual returns to that point more than once, because it matters.

How to use this manual

- If you just installed the wallet, read chapters 2 and 3, then chapter 4 on security before you put any real BAD into it.
- If you want to understand a particular tab, jump to chapter 6.
- If you are comfortable with a command line, chapter 7 covers the built-in console and the most useful commands.
- Chapter 11 is a glossary. Any unfamiliar term is probably explained there.

Note. BadCoin Core is a self-custody wallet. There is no support desk that can reset your password or recover your coins. Your backup is your safety net. Chapter 4 shows you how to make one.

2. The story of BadCoin

BadCoin began in 2018 as a fork of Bitcoin Core, the same software that runs the Bitcoin network. A fork means the BadCoin developers took Bitcoin's open-source code as a starting point and changed it to build their own independent coin and network. BadCoin has its own blockchain, its own coin (ticker BAD), and its own community. It is not Bitcoin and it is not pegged to Bitcoin in any way.

A coin anyone can mine

The defining choice the BadCoin developers made was to support five separate proof-of-work mining algorithms instead of one. Bitcoin uses a single algorithm, SHA-256d, which in practice is mined only by purpose-built industrial hardware. BadCoin accepts blocks mined with SHA-256d, Scrypt, Groestl, Skein, or Yescrypt. Several of those, Yescrypt in particular, are friendly to ordinary computer processors. The intent was a coin that a person could still mine at home on a normal machine. That idea is the reason the wallet you are holding has a full Mining tab built in.

Because five algorithms contribute work to one chain, BadCoin uses a combined calculation to weigh their mining work fairly, and a difficulty system (DarkGravityWave) that retargets quickly so no single algorithm can run away with the chain. Blocks arrive roughly once a minute on average, though the real interval varies quite a lot from block to block.

A quiet period, and a chain that split

Like many small projects, BadCoin went through a long quiet period. Maintainer attention became sporadic, the build tooling aged, and at one point the network's history split into two competing versions of the chain. A community contributor, jegertabt, isolated and tested the two and found that one of them, often called the canonical chain, was the stronger and valid one: it shares history with the older chain up to block 1,773,006, then diverges, and from that point it carries more accumulated mining work, more blocks, and passes deep validation cleanly. On 19 May 2026 it was brought back online as the official BadCoin chain, with a re-indexed explorer and a working mining pool.

Back in active development

BadCoin is being actively maintained again. The wallet you are running, BadCoin Core, has been rebuilt so that it compiles and runs on modern computers, and given a set of practical tools: the Mining tab, the Overview dashboard, the My Addresses page, and more, all covered later in this manual.

One point is worth being precise about. The software has been brought up to date, but the blockchain itself is unchanged. The coin, the 21-billion BAD supply ceiling, the network rules, and every existing balance are all exactly as they were. Updating to this wallet does not move your coins or create new ones. It is the same BadCoin network, with software that builds and runs again on a modern machine.

3. Installing and first run

Installing on macOS

BadCoin Core for macOS is delivered as a disk image, a file ending in .dmg. Double-click it and a window opens showing the BadCoin Core application next to a shortcut to your Applications folder. Drag the application onto the Applications folder to install it, then eject the disk image.

The first time you open the wallet, macOS may show a warning that it cannot verify the developer. This happens when a build is not code-signed with an Apple Developer certificate. To open it, right-click (or Control-click) the application icon, choose Open, and confirm; or allow it under System Settings, Privacy and Security. You only need to do this once. After that the wallet opens normally.

The startup splash

Each time the wallet starts it shows a splash screen while it loads the block index. The status line along the bottom tells you what it is doing.

First run: syncing the chain

On first launch the wallet connects to the BadCoin network and begins downloading and verifying the blockchain. Because it is a full node, this takes time and disk space, and the wallet is not fully ready until it finishes. The Overview tab shows the sync progress. A bar across the bottom of the window appears while the wallet is catching up and disappears once it is current.

The wallet keeps its data, including your wallet file and the downloaded blockchain, in the BadCoin data directory. On macOS that is:

```
~/Library/Application Support/Badcoin/
```

Inside that folder, the file `wallet.dat` holds your keys and is the single most important file to back up (see chapter 4). The file `badcoin.conf` holds optional settings. The wallet runs fine with no configuration file at all, but if the node is slow to find the network you can create one with a known peer:

```
# ~/Library/Application Support/Badcoin/badcoin.conf
addnode=194.238.30.30:19012
```

Note. If a freshly installed node will not start syncing because it considers the chain tip too old, start it once with a larger maximum tip age (`-maxtipage=2000000000`), then remove the setting once it has caught up.

4. Keeping your wallet safe

BadCoin Core puts you in full control of your coins. That control only means something if you also protect them. This is the most important chapter in the manual.

Encrypt your wallet

Encrypting the wallet locks your private keys behind a passphrase. Without it, anyone who can open the wallet file can spend your coins. To encrypt, open the Settings menu and choose Encrypt Wallet. You will be asked to enter a passphrase twice.

Once encrypted, the wallet stays locked. You can still receive coins and watch balances while locked, but to send coins or to reveal a private key the wallet asks for the passphrase and unlocks just long enough to do the job. You can change the passphrase later from Settings, Change Passphrase.

Note. If you forget your passphrase, your coins are gone. There is no recovery and no reset. Choose a passphrase you will not lose, and store it somewhere safe and separate from the computer. Write it down.

Back up your wallet

Encryption protects against theft. A backup protects against a failed disk, a lost laptop, or a mistake. Use the File menu, Backup Wallet, and save a copy of the wallet file somewhere safe: an external drive, ideally more than one location. Make a fresh backup whenever you have created a batch of new addresses.

A backup of an encrypted wallet is still encrypted, so it is safe to store the backup and the passphrase is still required to use it. Keep the passphrase separate from the backup so that losing one does not mean losing both.

Paper wallets and private keys

The Receive tab can reveal the private key behind any of your addresses and save it as a printable PDF paper wallet (chapter 6). A paper wallet kept offline is one of the safest long-term backups there is. It is also the most dangerous thing to mishandle: a private key is the coins. Anyone who reads it can take them. Reveal keys only on a screen nobody is watching, and never send a private key to anyone or paste it into a website.

5. The main window

When the wallet is open and synced you see the main window. Along the top is a row of tabs, the toolbar. Selecting a tab changes what fills the rest of the window. The tabs are:

Tab	What it is for
Overview	Your balances at a glance, the live network status, coin maturity, and a list of recent transactions.
Send	Send BAD to another address.
Receive	Create a receiving address or payment request, and reveal or export a private key.
Transactions	The full, searchable history of everything this wallet has sent and received.
My Addresses	Every receiving address this wallet owns, each with its own balance.
Vanity Address	Generate a custom address that begins with letters you choose.
Mining	Mine BAD on this computer, solo or through a pool.

Each tab has its own chapter section below. Above the tabs are the usual menus (File, Settings, Help), covered in chapter 8. The status bar along the very bottom of the window shows the connection count, the sync state, and whether the wallet is encrypted and locked.

6. The tabs in detail

6.1 Overview

Overview is the home screen. At the top it shows your balance, broken into parts so you always know what you can actually spend:

- **Available** is the balance you can spend right now.
- **Pending** is incoming coins that have arrived but are not yet confirmed enough to spend.
- **Immature** is freshly mined coins. Mined rewards must age about 100 blocks before they can be spent. Until then they are real but locked.
- **Total** is all of the above added together.

Below the balance, BadCoin Core adds two panels that standard Bitcoin Core does not have. The **Network Status** panel shows, live, whether you are synced, the current block height, how many peers you are connected to, the network you are on, the age of the last block, and the size of the mempool. The **Coin Maturity** panel appears only when you are holding freshly mined coins: it shows a progress bar for the next reward to unlock, how many rewards are still maturing, and an honest estimate of when they will become spendable, based on the chain's recently observed block pace rather than a fixed assumption. The lower part of the tab lists your most recent transactions.

6.2 Send

The Send tab is where you pay BAD to someone else. Paste or type the recipient's BadCoin address into the Pay To field, optionally add a label so the payment is easy to recognise later in your history, and enter the amount. You can send to more than one recipient at once by adding further rows.

The wallet adds a small network fee so miners include your transaction. Before anything leaves your wallet you are shown a confirmation summary with the amount and the fee. If the wallet is encrypted it asks for your passphrase at this point. Nothing is sent until you confirm. Sent payments appear immediately in the Transactions tab and settle as the network confirms them.

Note. A BadCoin address is a long string of letters and numbers, and receiving addresses from this wallet begin with a capital B. Always check the first and last few characters of an address before sending. Transactions cannot be reversed.

6.3 Receive

The Receive tab creates addresses for people to pay you. Fill in an optional label and amount and the wallet produces a fresh receiving address and a QR code that a payer can scan. Reusing one address for everything works, but a new address per payment keeps your history easier to read and is better for privacy.

The Receive dialog for an address also carries two extra features. **Show / Export Private Key** reveals, behind a clear warning, the private key for that address in text and as a QR code. **Save as PDF** turns the address and its private key, both as QR codes, into a printable paper wallet. Printed and stored offline, that sheet is a durable cold backup of those coins.

Note. Treat an exported private key, and the PDF, as cash. Whoever holds it controls the coins. See chapter 4.

6.4 Transactions

The Transactions tab is the complete record of everything this wallet has sent and received: the date, the type, the address and label, and the amount, with incoming amounts in one colour and outgoing in another. You can search by label or address and filter by date or type. Double-click any row for the full detail, including the transaction ID, the number of confirmations, and the fee. The Export button writes the visible list to a CSV file for your records.

6.5 My Addresses

My Addresses is a full page, not a popup, listing every receiving address this wallet owns. For each address it shows the label, the address itself, and that address's own balance, with any immature mined portion marked separately. This is the easiest way to see where your coins actually sit.

- **New** generates a fresh receiving address.
- **Copy** copies the selected address to the clipboard.
- **Edit label** is done in place: double-click a label to rename it. The new name is saved to the wallet.
- **Export Private Key** opens the same warning-gated reveal and paper-wallet export described under Receive.
- **Remove** takes an address off the list. Only an address with a zero balance can be removed, so you cannot lose coins this way.

6.6 Vanity Address

A vanity address is an ordinary BadCoin address whose text happens to begin with letters you chose. The Vanity Address tab finds one for you. There is no trick to it: the wallet generates real keypairs one after another, very fast, until one of them produces an address that starts the way you asked.

Type one or more desired prefixes, one per line, and press Start search. Every BadCoin address from this wallet begins with a capital B, so your prefix must too. The tab is honest about what is possible. Each extra character makes the search roughly 58 times harder, and the character right after the B can only take certain values. If you ask for a prefix that can never occur, the search detects it within a moment and tells you, rather than running forever. While it runs you see a live count, the search speed, and how many matches have been found.

A found address is a genuine keypair. Select it and press Save to wallet to keep it: it then becomes one of your receiving addresses, usable everywhere in the wallet, and you can export its private key from the My Addresses tab. Delete removes a result you do not want.

Note. A found vanity address is held only in memory until you save it. If you want to keep one, use Save to wallet before closing the tab.

6.7 Mining

The Mining tab lets you mine BAD on this computer. Because BadCoin is a multi-algorithm chain, mining is genuinely open to ordinary machines, and this tab is the friendly front end for it. Standard Bitcoin Core has no mining interface at all.

Choose a payout address (the New button beside it generates one), pick a mining algorithm, and choose a mode:

- **Solo** mining works your local node directly. Every block you find is yours in full, but on a live chain a solo block can take a long time.
- **Pool** mining joins your effort with other miners through a mining pool and shares the rewards in proportion to the work contributed. It pays out more steadily. The tab keeps four pool presets so your favourite pool URLs are one click away.

Yescrypt is the most processor-friendly of the five algorithms and is the usual choice for mining on a normal computer. Press Start Mining to begin and Stop to end. While mining you see a live status, the count of blocks or shares for the session, and the last block hash.

Below that is the **Mining Rewards** chart, with buttons for a 1 day, 1 week, 1 month, or 1 year view. In solo mode the chart is drawn from your wallet's real mined-reward history, so it shows genuine earnings over the period you choose. Under the chart, an animated pixel miner swings a pickaxe while you mine and celebrates when a block is found. It is there for character; it has no effect on mining.

7. The debug console and node tools

Everything in the wallet can be done with the tabs and menus. The debug console is for when you want to look deeper or do something the menus do not cover. Open it from the Help menu, Debug window.

The Debug window

The Debug window has several tabs of its own:

- **Information** shows the wallet version, the network, the current block count, the number of connections, and other node details.
- **Console** is an interactive command line into your own node.
- **Network Traffic** graphs data sent and received over time.
- **Peers** lists the other nodes you are connected to, with details on each when selected.

Using the console

In the Console tab you type a command and press Return. Type `help` for the full list of commands, or `help <command>` for detail on one. The console only ever talks to your own node on your own machine.

Note. The console can reveal private keys and can send coins. Never paste a command into it because someone told you to, especially someone offering help or support. A command you do not understand can empty your wallet.

Useful commands

These are some of the commands most worth knowing. Items shown in angle brackets are values you supply.

Command	What it does
<code>getblockchaininfo</code>	The chain state: current height, sync progress, and which network you are on.
<code>getwalletinfo</code>	Wallet state: balance, key-pool size, and encryption and lock status.
<code>getnetworkinfo</code>	Connection and version detail for your node.
<code>getbalance</code>	Your total spendable balance.
<code>getnewaddress</code>	Create a new receiving address.
<code>listtransactions</code>	The most recent transactions for this wallet.

Command	What it does
sendtoaddress <address> <amount>	Send BAD to an address.
dumpprivkey <address>	Reveal the private key for one of your addresses. Handle with great care.
importprivkey <key>	Import an address from its private key.
backupwallet <path>	Save a backup copy of the wallet file.
encryptwallet <passphrase>	Encrypt a not-yet-encrypted wallet.
walletpassphrase <pass> <seconds>	Unlock an encrypted wallet for a set time.
setminingalgo <algo>	Choose which of the five algorithms this node mines with. Specific to BadCoin.
getmininginfo	Mining-related state for the node.
help	List every command, or explain one.
stop	Shut the node down cleanly.

8. Menus and other features

File menu

- **Backup Wallet** saves a copy of the wallet file. See chapter 4.
- **Sign Message** proves you control an address by signing a piece of text with its private key, without revealing the key.
- **Verify Message** checks a signature someone else produced against their address.
- **Sending and Receiving addresses** open the classic address books.

Settings menu

- **Encrypt Wallet** sets a passphrase on a wallet that does not yet have one. See chapter 4.
- **Change Passphrase** replaces the encryption passphrase.
- **Options** covers network settings such as a proxy, the size of the database cache, whether the wallet starts at login, and the unit BAD amounts are displayed in.

Help menu

- **Debug window** opens the console and node tools described in chapter 7.
- **Command-line options** lists every option the node accepts at startup.
- **About BadCoin Core** shows the version and build information.

9. The five mining algorithms

BadCoin accepts blocks mined with any of five proof-of-work algorithms. Each block is mined with one algorithm; the chain combines the work of all five. You choose which one your node mines with, in the Mining tab or with the `setminingalgo` command.

Algorithm	Character	Notes
Yescript	Processor-friendly	The usual choice for mining on a normal computer. Memory-hard and resistant to specialised hardware.
Scrypt	Processor / GPU	Long-established and widely understood.
Groestl	Processor / GPU	Fast and efficient to verify.
Skein	Processor / GPU	A modern, well-regarded hash function.
SHA-256d	Specialised hardware	The same algorithm Bitcoin uses. Not practical to mine on a normal computer.

Using several algorithms spreads out the mining and makes it harder for any single kind of hardware, or any single miner, to dominate the chain. It is the reason a person can still meaningfully mine BadCoin at home, and the reason this wallet ships with mining built in.

10. BadCoin at a glance

Coin name and ticker	BadCoin, ticker BAD
Smallest unit	1 BAD = 100,000,000 satoshis
Maximum supply	21,000,000,000 BAD
Launched	2018, as a fork of Bitcoin Core
Software base	Bitcoin Core 0.16.3 engine
Mining	Proof-of-work, five algorithms
Target block time	About one minute on average (it varies)
Difficulty	DarkGravityWave, retargets every block
Mined-reward maturity	About 100 confirmations before a reward can be spent
Receiving addresses	Begin with a capital B
Your wallet file	wallet.dat, in the Badcoin data directory

11. Glossary

Address. A string of letters and numbers that coins can be sent to. BadCoin receiving addresses begin with a capital B.

Blockchain. The shared, public record of every BadCoin transaction, agreed by the whole network.

Confirmation. A block built on top of the block holding your transaction. More confirmations means more settled.

Full node. Software that downloads and independently verifies the whole blockchain. BadCoin Core is one.

Immature. A freshly mined reward that exists but cannot be spent yet, until it has aged about 100 blocks.

Mempool. The waiting room of transactions that have been broadcast but not yet mined into a block.

Mining. Doing computational work to add a block to the chain, in exchange for a reward in newly created BAD.

Private key. The secret behind an address. Whoever holds it controls the coins. Never share it.

Proof of work. The mechanism by which miners compete to add blocks, by spending real computing effort.

Satoshi. The smallest unit of BAD. One BAD is 100,000,000 satoshis.

Sync. The process of a node catching up to the current tip of the blockchain.

Wallet file. wallet.dat, the file holding your keys. Back it up.

12. What is next, and getting help

On the roadmap

BadCoin Core is an active project. Work already planned beyond this release includes:

- **Signed and notarized builds**, so the wallet installs with no security warning.
- **Bad Pixies**, a native on-chain collectible layer for BadCoin. Bad Pixies are minted and owned at the protocol level, and will appear as an NFTs tab inside this wallet. It is a future network upgrade and needs community ratification, so it arrives after this release.
- **A companion iPhone wallet**, for holding and receiving BAD on the go.
- **Continued modernization** of the core, bringing in improvements made to Bitcoin Core since the 2018 base.

Getting help

If something looks wrong, the Debug window (chapter 7) is the first place to look: the Information tab tells you whether the node is synced and connected. A wallet that shows no balance is very often simply still syncing. A balance that shows as immature is mined coins that have not yet aged; they will mature on their own.

For anything else, the BadCoin community is the place to turn. And before you ask for help anywhere, remember the one rule that protects you: nobody legitimate will ever need your private key or your wallet passphrase. Anyone who asks for either is trying to take your coins.